publisher of Westland. Special thanks to my editor Kushal Gulab who worked on the structure and content of the manuscript with great skill and complete devotion. I also wish to express my gratitude to other outstanding members of Westland Publications for their immense contributions, especially Niyati Bhat and Vidhi Bhargava. My family deserves special mention for accepting my abrupt absence from their lives at regular intervals since writing this book has been consuming. My friends and colleagues at Net-workl8, The New Indian Express too have been an endless source of strength. Finally, I feel deeply grateful to the elders in the profession, especially Ajay Singh and B.V. Rao for offering their wisdom.

I would like to conclude by expressing sincere gratitude to two people. I know I can't reveal your identity but this book is an ode to both of you.